> “Electricity … **may** help to keep a **vain Man** humble.”
>
> **Benjamin Franklin**, 1747

a spark inside the box. This experiment was later repeated by several scientists, albeit with one fatality.

With the help of his son, Franklin also conducted an experiment with a kite in a thunderstorm. The kite was attached to some wet string, which had a key tied to its lower end. As the kite entered the thunderclouds, the electrical charge in the clouds was drawn down the string, causing the key to emit sparks, demonstrating that the clouds were electrified. Having shown that lightning and electrical charge were the same, Franklin published his theories and experiments in 1752, to global acclaim. His work also led to his invention of the lightning conductor, which, when attached to buildings, conducts lightning safely to Earth.

Inventions and beyond

Franklin devised several other inventions, including a heat-efficient stove, bifocal glasses, and a “glass armonica” (a musical instrument that uses glass bowls to produce notes). He also charted the current that flows eastward across the North Atlantic Ocean, naming it the Gulf Stream. A high-ranking diplomat heavily involved in government politics, Franklin also helped in drafting the Declaration of Independence, making him one of America’s Founding Fathers.

HIS RESEARCH LED TO THE INVENTION OF **THE BATTERY**

REFUSED TO PATENT HIS **INVENTIONS** AND GAVE THEM TO THE WORLD FOR **FREE**